

Chromatic Orb Spell Audit Report

1. Current Implementation Details

File: Assets/Scripts/Magic/SpellDatabase_C.cs (lines 142-158)

Field	Value
SpellId	chromatic_orb
Name	“Chromatic Orb”
Description	“Ranged touch attack deals 1d8 damage (type varies by caster level). At CL3: fire, 1d8.”
SpellLevel	1
School	Evocation
ClassList	Wizard
TargetType	SingleEnemy
RangeSquares	5 (Close range — 25 ft.)
IsTouch	true
IsRangedTouch	true
EffectType	Damage
DamageDice	d8
DamageCount	1
DamageType	“fire”
ActionType	Standard
ProvokesAoO	true
AllowsSavingThrow	(not set — defaults to false)
SpellResistanceApplies	(not set — defaults to false)
Components	(not set — no V/S/M defined)

Additional notes: There is no special effect handling code anywhere in the codebase referencing `chromatic_orb` or `CHROMATIC_ORB` beyond the spell registration and the `SpellNames` identifier constant. No caster-level-based damage type switching logic exists.

2. Official D&D 3.5e Rules for “Chromatic Orb”

 Critical Finding: Chromatic Orb Does NOT Exist in D&D 3.5e

Chromatic Orb is NOT a D&D 3.5 Edition spell. It does not appear in the D&D 3.5e Player’s Handbook, SRD, Spell Compendium, or any official 3.5e first-party supplement.

The spell’s publication history:

Edition	Source	Notes
AD&D 1e	Unearthed Arcana (1985)	1st-level Illusionist spell with level-scaled color effects (light → death)
AD&D 2e	The Complete Wizard’s Handbook (1990)	1st-level Wizard spell, Alteration/Evocation school
D&D 3.0/3.5e	Does not exist	Not in PHB, SRD, or any official supplement
D&D 5e	Player’s Handbook (2014)	1st-level Evocation, 3d8 damage, choose type, 90 ft range

Closest 3.5e Equivalent: Lesser Orb Spells (Spell Compendium)

The Spell Compendium (3.5e) includes a family of **Lesser Orb** spells (not “Chromatic Orb”):

Spell	Level	School	Damage	Range	Save	SR
Lesser Orb of Acid	1	Conjuration (Creation)	1d8/2 CL (max 5d8)	Close	None	No
Lesser Orb of Cold	1	Conjuration (Creation)	1d8/2 CL (max 5d8)	Close	None	No
Lesser Orb of Electricity	1	Conjuration (Creation)	1d8/2 CL (max 5d8)	Close	None	No
Lesser Orb of Fire	1	Conjuration (Creation)	1d8/2 CL (max 5d8)	Close	None	No
Lesser Orb of Sound	1	Conjuration (Creation)	1d6/2 CL (max 5d6)	Close	None	No

Key traits of the Lesser Orb spells:

- **School:** Conjuration (Creation) — **not** Evocation
- **Components:** V, S
- **Range:** Close (25 ft. + 5 ft./2 levels)
- **Attack:** Ranged touch attack
- **Damage:** Starts at 1d8 at CL 1, gains +1d8 per 2 caster levels (CL 3 = 2d8, CL 5 = 3d8, etc.), max 5d8 at CL 9
- **Saving Throw:** None
- **Spell Resistance:** No (major feature — bypasses SR)
- **Duration:** Instantaneous
- **No material component** (just V, S)

AD&D 2e Chromatic Orb (for reference)

If the implementation is intended to reflect the AD&D version:

- **Level:** 1st (Illusionist/Wizard)
- **School:** Alteration/Evocation
- **Components:** V, S, M (gem worth 50+ gp, consumed)
- **Range:** 30 yards
- **Attack:** Normal attack roll with distance-based bonuses
- **Damage & Effects scale by caster level:**
 - CL 1: White (1d4, light effect)
 - CL 2: Red (1d6, heat/debuff)
 - CL 3: Orange (1d8, fire/ignition)
 - CL 4: Yellow (1d10, blindness)
 - CL 5: Green (1d12, stinking cloud)

- CL 6: Turquoise (2d8, magnetism)
- CL 7: Blue (2d16, paralysis)
- CL 10: Violet (petrification)
- CL 12: Black (death)
- **Saving Throw:** Negates special effect (not damage)
- **SR:** N/A (AD&D didn't use SR system)

3. Discrepancies

Since Chromatic Orb doesn't exist in D&D 3.5e, **every aspect of this spell is a discrepancy with the 3.5e PHB** — the spell simply isn't in the book. However, comparing against the most likely intended sources:

If intended as a 3.5e Spell Compendium “Lesser Orb” spell:

Aspect	Current Implementation	Lesser Orb (Spell Compendium)	Status
Name	“Chromatic Orb”	“Lesser Orb of [element]”	✗ Wrong name
School	Evocation	Conjuration (Creation)	✗ Wrong school
Damage scaling	Fixed 1d8 (no scaling)	1d8 per 2 CL (max 5d8)	✗ Missing scaling
Damage type	Hardcoded “fire”	Varies per spell variant	⚠ Partially wrong — should be one specific type per spell, or let player choose
Saving Throw	None (default false)	None	✓ Correct
Spell Resistance	No (default false)	No	✓ Correct (but for wrong reason — Conjuration bypasses SR, not Evocation)
Range	Close (5 squares)	Close (25 ft. + 5 ft./2 CL)	⚠ Base correct, but no scaling defined
Components	Not specified	V, S (no material)	⚠ Missing
Attack type	Ranged touch	Ranged touch	✓ Correct
Class list	Wizard only	Sorcerer/Wizard	✗ Missing Sorcerer

If intended as an AD&D 2e Chromatic Orb adaptation:

Aspect	Current Implementation	AD&D 2e Chromatic Orb	Status
Damage at CL 3	1d8 fire	1d8 fire (orange orb)	✓ Matches for CL 3 specifically
CL-based scaling	None implemented	Full color/damage/effect table	✗ Missing all scaling
Special effects	None	Light, heat, fire, blindness, paralysis, petrification, death	✗ Missing entirely
Material component	Not specified	Gem worth 50+ gp (consumed)	✗ Missing
Saving throw	None	Save negates special effect	✗ Missing
School	Evocation	Alteration/Evocation	⚠ Partially correct

4. Recommendations

Option A: Remove the spell (Strict 3.5e PHB adherence)

Since Chromatic Orb doesn't exist in 3.5e, the cleanest approach for PHB-only accuracy is to **remove it** and replace it with the official **Lesser Orb** spells from the Spell Compendium if desired.

Option B: Replace with Lesser Orb spells (3.5e Spell Compendium)

Replace the single "Chromatic Orb" with the official Lesser Orb spell family:

1. Change school from Evocation → **Conjuration (Creation)**
2. Add **damage scaling**: 1d8 per 2 caster levels, max 5d8 at CL 9
3. Create separate spell entries per element (acid, cold, electricity, fire, sound) OR implement element choice at cast time
4. Add **Sorcerer** to the class list
5. Set components to V, S
6. Confirm range scales properly (Close: 25 ft. + 5 ft./2 CL)
7. Keep: No saving throw, No SR, Ranged touch attack

Option C: Keep as custom/homebrew spell (clearly mark it)

If the intent is to keep a simplified "chromatic orb" as a custom spell:

1. **Mark it as non-PHB/custom** in spell data (the range audit already flags it as non-PHB)
2. Add damage scaling (currently flat 1d8 is very weak for higher levels)
3. Consider adding element choice at cast time
4. Document that this is a homebrew adaptation

Priority Fix (regardless of option chosen):

- **Damage scaling is missing** — flat 1d8 with no CL scaling makes this spell nearly useless past level 1
 - **Sorcerer should be on the class list** if keeping the spell
 - **School should be Conjunction** if aligning with Spell Compendium orb spells
-

Report generated: May 8, 2026

Codebase: /home/ubuntu/dnd35prototype